

## Anonymous Cover-Letter Template

[Submission date]

Editors of *Blockchains*

Special Issue: Feature Papers in Blockchains 2026

Dear Editors,

Please consider the Review manuscript entitled “Blockchain-Assisted Mission Trust in Air–Surface–Underwater Unmanned Systems: A Cross-Layer Review and Object–Assurance–Lifecycle Framework” for publication in *Blockchains* and consideration in the Special Issue “Feature Papers in Blockchains 2026.” Author and institutional details are withheld in this file for double-anonymous review and will be supplied through the submission system as required.

The manuscript reviews cross-domain UAV–USV–UUV cooperation, unmanned-system security, trust and reputation, provenance, remote attestation, zero trust, and permissioned blockchain governance. Its principal original synthesis is the Object–Assurance–Lifecycle framework, which distinguishes four mission objects, four complementary assurance layers, and six lifecycle stages. The manuscript also proposes an object-dependency threat grammar, a context–temporal–graph evidence loop, a six-level evidence-maturity ladder, and a future Cross-Domain Unmanned Trust Profile.

The review is closely aligned with the journal because it identifies where permissioned ledgers materially support multi-organization membership, attestation and provenance commitments, policy/model coordination, audit accountability, and reconciliation after network partition. It assigns physical corroboration, endpoint protection, privacy, hard real-time performance, and governance to complementary assurance mechanisms. As a narrative review and conceptual synthesis, the article develops its findings from the cited literature and the accompanying evidence inventory.

This manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has been approved by all authors. Any related manuscripts and potential conflicts will be disclosed in the submission system. The authors will supply complete CRediT contributions, funding information, affiliations, and corresponding-author details after peer review or whenever the Editorial Office requires them. Its evidence base comprises public, non-sensitive sources suitable for reproducible scholarly review.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

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